Rachel Reid

Senior Product Designer · Design Systems · Accessibility · Builds with Claude Code

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PROFILE

Product designer with four years at fintech startup Ascent Platform, from early stage to Series A. I created the company's design system from scratch in React and MUI, made it WCAG compliant, and am now leading the app's migration onto it.

I design and build front-end UI with Claude Code, prototyping in working code on the real design system instead of static mock-ups. I work with international clients, including lenders in the US.

EXPERIENCE

Product Experience Specialist (Lead UX/UI Designer) July 2022 – present

Ascent Platform, via Hollis Creative · Fintech lending platform, early stage to Series A

Design system and accessibility

- Created Ascent's design system from scratch: more than 100 React components built on MUI, following Material 3 and customised for the brand, with usage and accessibility guidelines for each component.
- Wrote the accessibility guidelines and component changes needed to meet WCAG 2.1 AA, covering keyboard use, focus, contrast and ARIA.
- Leading the migration of the live app onto the new accessible system, about half complete, auditing each page's UI and UX and redesigning where needed.
- Restructured the colour theme into light and dark roles to ship dark mode, and to support white-label skins in each client's brand colours.
- Redesigning the platform, built for desktop only, to work on mobile, borrowers first, with every redesigned component responsive.
- Designed the team's Claude Code workflow for the design system: commands that create, review and check usage of components, audit pages into Jira tickets and run those tickets end to end, plus a coaching agent for junior engineers.

Product design and front end

- Design and ship new features end to end, from discovery with founders, clients and lenders to release.
- Led the loan reviews and renewals feature, replacing email, letters and fax with one trackable flow for lenders and borrowers.
- Prototype in working code with Claude Code and Claude artifacts built on the design system, so stakeholders and engineers review real UI, not static files.
- Build front-end UI in React with Claude Code, and hand off cleanly to engineers for back-end work.
- Built Claude Code quality-control commands that developers run on front-end work, catching design system, accessibility and consistency issues before code review.

Leadership

- Stepped up as lead UX designer: guide and give structured feedback to junior designers and support their onboarding.
- Work daily with founders, product managers and engineers to set priorities and balance user needs with business goals.
- Review every pull request that touches UI, from any developer, for component use, guidelines, consistency and UX.
- Ran remote research sessions with a US lender client, then designed and built the front end of the fixes: a reviews overview, a documents overview and request deduplication.

Product Designer (freelance) Oct 2026 – present

Frank Bean Market · UK laser-engraved gifts shop on Shopify, Etsy and eBay

- Audited and redesigned the Shopify store with Claude Code, from priorities to production code and data.
- Rebuilt navigation around how people shop for gifts: by product, occasion and interest. Added 11 occasion collections and 4 storefront filters.
- Rewrote, tagged and added alt text to 191 products using scripted bulk edits with dry runs, backups and verification.
- Fixed a header menu that closed on tap, adding keyboard (Escape) support and 48 px targets, and shipped it to the live store.
- Made personalisation clearer: a "how it works" homepage section and a longer, better-labelled engraving text field.

SKILLS

Design: product discovery, user flows, end-to-end feature design, design systems, Material 3, accessibility (WCAG 2.1 AA), prototyping, journey mapping

AI and build: Claude Code, Claude artifacts, React, MUI, Storybook, Git and GitHub, Shopify

Tools: Figma (advanced), VS Code, Notion, Excalidraw, Adobe Creative Cloud

EDUCATION

BSc (Hons) Digital Interaction Design, 2:1 · University of Dundee, 2022